3. Project Planning Phase

Introduction

The **Project Planning Phase** is an essential step in the development of the **Smart Library Request Workflow in ServiceNow**. In this phase, the overall project structure, timeline, and implementation strategy are defined. Proper planning ensures that the system is developed in an organized and systematic manner.

This phase includes defining project milestones, identifying stakeholders involved in the project, and creating a step-by-step roadmap for the implementation process. Effective planning helps reduce risks, improves coordination among participants, and ensures that the project objectives are achieved successfully.

Project Milestones

Milestones represent the key stages in the project development process. Each milestone marks the completion of an important activity that contributes to the overall system implementation.

In this project, the major milestones include defining user roles, designing the required database tables, and creating workflows for managing borrow requests and approvals.

Role Definition

The first milestone is identifying and configuring the system roles required for the application. In the Smart Library Request Workflow, two primary roles are defined: **Student** and **Librarian**.

- The **Student role** allows users to search for books, request books, and track request status.
- The **Librarian role** allows users to manage books and approve or reject borrowing requests.

Example

When a student logs into the system, they will only see options related to searching and requesting books. A librarian, however, will see

additional options such as adding books, updating book status, and approving requests.

Table Structure Design

Another major milestone is designing the database tables that will store the information required for the system.

Two main tables are created in ServiceNow:

1. **u_book table**
2. **u_borrow_request table**

These tables help store and organize information about books and borrowing transactions.

u_book Table Example Fields

- Book ID
- Book Name
- Author Name
- Category
- Availability Status